Brahminism and Bhakti were brothers under the skin with orthodox Islam and Sufism, respectively.

Consequently, by 1400 CE or so, big temples across India almost stopped placing erotic art on their walls—a very visible link between sex and religion had been broken. The very role and function of temples in public life began changing, partly also as their wealth and patronage declined under the Indo-Muslim rule. As temples leaned more on ordinary people for their survival, they started becoming mere sites of worship. But that wasn't all; other deep cultural changes were also afoot. Fewer and fewer Hindus now read the *Kamasutra*, had casual sexual escapades, wrote erotic poetry or married out of caste. The purpose of sex became more closely aligned with procreation, as the Manusmriti advocated in the early first century CE. Control of women's sexuality increased, not the least to preserve the sanctity of caste. While the status of women in Chandela times wasn't great by twenty-first century yardsticks, it arguably worsened from then on. Much of this conservative turn was led by forces indigenous to Hinduism.[52]

The masses flocked to the devotional ecstasies of Tulsidas, Surdas, Mirabai, Eknath and Chaitanya Mahaprabhu. Tantra began receding to the fringe, where it survives to this day. With its shrinking, Hindu culture too changed significantly, eventually producing men like Vivekananda, who proclaimed Sita as the ideal Hindu woman, and Gandhi, with his famous hang-ups about sex. This profound cultural change is why Hindus now find it hard to relate to the world view that inspired Khajuraho's art. That's why powerful Hindu groups now harass urban young women who date men or go to bars. That's also why they hounded out M.F. Husain for painting naked Hindu goddesses and Doniger for her book cover showing Lord Krishna sitting on the 'buttocks of a naked woman surrounded by other naked women'.[53] Such prudery would have drawn amused laughter from the average Chandela aristocrat.

Two responses dominate today: On the one hand, Hindu conservatives see nothing wrong with the powerful strain of sexual prudery in Indian society, taking it not only as good but as the very essence of Sanatan Dharma. They usually blame 'Western culture' for the more permissive sexual mores around them. Rather than trying to understand how Hindu India once had a robust 'appreciation of eroticism', they are far more